

Gihan Shavinda Rathnayake

Cybersecurity Intern | Aspiring Purple Team Analyst | Security Engineering Enthusiast

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SUMMARY

IT graduate awaiting official graduation, seeking a Security Engineering / Purple Team internship. Built four end-to-end cybersecurity projects in detection engineering, attack simulation, and detection validation across network threats, AWS identity attack paths, SOC operations, and software supply-chain security. Also brings professional secure-API development experience with JWT authentication, RBAC, and API security testing.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Detection & Purple Team: Detection Engineering, Attack Simulation, Detection Validation, Sigma Rules, MITRE ATT&CK Mapping, Threat Hunting, UEBA, Event Correlation, Incident Response, Anomaly Detection

Network Security: Wireshark, TShark, Tcpdump, Nmap, Suricata, Network Traffic Analysis, IDS/IPS, TCP/IP, Vulnerability Assessment

Cloud & Identity: AWS IAM, CloudTrail Analysis, Privilege-Escalation Analysis, Attack-Path Analysis, Blast-Radius Analysis, Neo4j, LocalStack, Google Cloud Platform

Application & Supply-Chain Security: REST API Security, JWT Authentication, RBAC, CVE/CVSS Analysis, OSV, Dependency Analysis, Secure Development

Development: Python, JavaScript, PHP, FastAPI, Angular, Laravel, Node.js, Express.js, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, Docker, Git, GitHub CI/CD, Postman, Linux, Windows

EXPERIENCE

Full-Stack Developer (Intern)

Mar 2025 – Nov 2025

Willsj Technologies LLC · Bur Dubai, UAE · Remote

- Engineered JWT-based authentication and role-based access control for 4 production APIs (PHP Laravel/MySQL), reducing unauthorized-access exposure across all user-facing endpoints and sessions.
- Hardened and validated REST APIs against injection and auth-bypass issues using Postman and API Dog within a Git/GitHub CI/CD workflow, applying secure-development practices at each release.
- Deployed and monitored services on Google Cloud, gaining hands-on exposure to cloud access configuration and application-layer security controls.

PROJECTS

SOCForge – Purple Team Network Threat Detection & Response Lab

🐙 GitHub

- Built and validated **2 complementary detection pipelines** – a behavioral Python detector and Suricata signature-based IDS – against authorized reconnaissance and service-enumeration activity in an isolated Kali Linux / Metasploitable2 lab.
- Captured ground-truth network evidence with Tcpdump, extracted structured packet fields with TShark, correlated findings into incidents, mapped activity to MITRE ATT&CK (including Network Service Scanning / T1046), and implemented human-approved response workflows with end-to-end evidence traceability.

CloudHunt – Agentless AWS Cloud Threat Detection & Response Platform

🐙 GitHub

- Developed an agentless platform that analyzes CloudTrail telemetry with behavioral and signature detections, reconstructs AssumeRole chains, and prioritizes incidents by blast radius.

- Modeled IAM privilege-escalation paths in Neo4j (attack paths identified) and evaluated detection accuracy on simulated attack scenarios with reversible, human-approved response actions.

SOCMind AI – Explainable AI Security Operations Platform

 GitHub

- Designed a human-in-the-loop SOC platform with Sigma-style rules, anomaly detection, UEBA, MITRE ATT&CK mapping, and attack-story reconstruction that correlates alerts into incidents.
- Secured the platform with RBAC/MFA, risk-aware response approvals, constrained investigation commands, and full audit logging of response actions.

DepGuard – Software Supply-Chain Security Scanner

 GitHub

- Engineered a multi-ecosystem scanner (npm, PHP, Python, Ruby, Go, Rust) that flags CVEs, typosquatting, and malicious install scripts using OSV data and behavioral heuristics, with an explainable 0–100 Trust Score; tested on 8 real projects.

EDUCATION

University of Moratuwa

2022 – 2026

B.Sc. (Hons) in Information Technology, Faculty of Information Technology

Maliyadewa Adarsha Maha Vidyalaya, Kurunegala

G.C.E. Advanced Level (2020) – Physical Science – Combined Mathematics A | Chemistry A | Physics C

G.C.E. Ordinary Level (2016) – 8 A | 1 B

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Cybersecurity & Ethical Hacking** – Academy of Future Robotics (4-month course, Grade A+, Nov 2025). Covered vulnerability assessment, cryptography, and network security.
- **Google Cybersecurity** – Foundations of Cybersecurity, Play It Safe: Manage Security Risks, Connect and Protect: Networks and Network Security
- **Cisco** – Security Operations Center (SOC)
- **TryHackMe** – Pre Security Learning Path

PUBLICATIONS

Jayathissa K.D.G.S., Bandara H.R.B.G.M., Nethma L.H.K., Karunarathna R.M.D.R.R., Siriwardane A.J.U., Kulawansa K.A.D.T., Lahiru R. “**Artista – Digital Art Marketplace.**” 9th International Conference on Information Technology Research (ICITR 2024), IEEE. ieeexplore.ieee.org/document/10857770

REFERENCES

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